

TAURANGA CLASSIC MOTORCYCLE CLUB

NEWSLETTER 9.

Our club run to Sapphire Springs was well supported (eleven machines). After a pleasant ride out to Katikati we were joined by two guys who rode down from Auckland. This shows real enthusiasm don't you think. After lunch we set out to meet up with the B.M.W. guys who had gathered together at the park side in the Karangahake Gorge. When we arrived there was roughly forty machines, some with sidecars. After chatting with them for some time we left for home.

A few members from the Club went over to Matamata on Sunday 24th October in answer to an invitation from the Vincent Owners Club, who were holding their Rally at the aerodrome. Lyall rode over on his 1950 350 A.J.S., Ivan on his Ducati, Bruce on his Jawa and I took my 29 A.J.S. which turned out to be the only Vintage machine there.

There were untold Vincents to be seen. Some restored beautifully, others not quite so good, although they all seemed to perform well.

I took part in some of the events, but didn't wait around for the results (I think it was probably just as well).

Ross won the raffle, a bottle of wine (an early Christmas present for our babysitter).

You will have received your entry form for the "Summer Rally" by now. Should you require any more, please just let us know.

That's all for now.

Jan and Ross.

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VINCENT RAPIDE

The world's fastest standard motor cycle is designed, constructed and marketed by one of the greatest motorcycle enthusiasts this era has seen, Mr Phillip Vincent. The "Rapide" is listed in the Vincent catalogue as the "slowest" of their three "V" type twins at 110 m.p.h. (the Black Shadow is listed as being able to do 125 m.p.h. and the Black Lightning at 150 m.p.h.!) The machine has a number of outstanding features, the Girdraulic front fork and rear springing being two.

In September 1950, Rollee Free established an American speed record of 156.58 m.p.h. on the salt flats in Utah on this machine. This Girdraulic fork, incidentally, is the result of several years of research by engineers and technicians who insisted on complete lateral rigidity and freedom from twist in all connecting members between wheels.

SPECIFICATIONS.

Engine: twin cylinder, O.H.V. air cooled, enclosed push rod operated valves, cylinder barrel - cast iron liner shrunk into finned aluminium cylinder jacket. Aluminium-alloy piston. Triple helical valve springs. Polished connecting rods, individually balanced flywheel.

Lubrication: Dry sump. Double acting rotary plunger pump.

Carburetors: Twin amals, type 289.

Clutch: Vincent patent Servo type.

Ignition: Gear driven Lucas magneto, specially laboratory tested.

Gas Capacity: $3\frac{3}{4}$ gallons.

Oil Capacity: Six pints. Oil tank forms upper frame member.

Brakes: Four internal expanding, 7" diameter. Drums finned for cooling.